

‘Russia will be willing to keep fighting for longer, and more bitterly.’

KONSTANTIN REMCHUKOV, *Moscow newspaper editor with Kremlin ties*

Putin benefits from Oval Office feud

Russia may exploit split to gain ground in Ukraine, dictate terms

By Anton Troianovski, Nataliya Vasilyeva, and Paul Sonne
NEW YORK TIMES
BERLIN — President Trump says he wants a quick cease-fire in Ukraine. But President Vladi-

mir Putin of Russia appears to be in no rush, and the blowup Friday between Trump and Ukraine’s president may give Russia’s leader the kind of ammunition he

needs to prolong the fight. With the United States’ alliance with Ukraine suffering a dramatic, public rupture, Putin now seems even more likely to hold out for a deal on his terms — and he could even be tempted to expand his push on the battlefield. The extraordinary scene in Washington — in which Trump lambasted President Volodymyr Zelensky of Ukraine — was broadcast as the top story on state television in Russia on Saturday morning. It played into three years of Kremlin propaganda casting Zelensky as a foolhardy ruler who would sooner or later exhaust the patience of his Western backers. UKRAINE, Page A4



A border runs through it

Tensions disrupt quiet repose of Vermont library that straddles the US-Canada line

By Paul Heintz
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT
DERBY LINE, Vt. — For decades, a scuffed-up line of electrical tape bisecting the floor of the Haskell Free Library & Opera House has marked the border between the United States and Canada inside what may be the only public building of its kind in the world. Visitors love to stand astride the makeshift boundary and pose for photos with American and Canadian flags perched nearby, said Kathy Converse, a retired English teacher who has spent the past two decades volunteering as a tour guide. “I just think it’s a perfect indication of how open this place is,” she said. “And that’s become a little more challenging lately.” Indeed, the growing tensions between the two nations have disrupted the quiet repose of this small-town gathering spot, which is open on equal terms

The Haskell Free Library & Opera House was built on the line to promote cross-border friendship. “I see the library as a little Switzerland,” said Sylvie Boudreau, volunteer president of the Haskell board of trustees.

BORDER, Page A6

Delays plague hearings for custody cases

Parents wait to plead for family reunification

By Jason Laughlin
GLOBE STAFF
About two years ago, a young stay-at-home mother lost custody of her 4-year-old daughter, due to substance abuse and mental health issues. The pain of that separation pushed her to reshape her life, and last May she and her husband, who then lived in Haverhill, welcomed their second child. But barely a day after the birth of their son, the Massachusetts Department of Children and Families again intervened and removed the newborn, citing postpartum depression and a failure to understand why she had lost custody of her daughter.

“There wasn’t really a reason for them to take him away,” said the mother, who asked not to be named to protect her privacy. “I hadn’t tested positive for substances. I wasn’t actively having a mental health crisis.” She and her husband were supposed to have a court hearing within three days to persuade a judge to reunite them with their baby, according to state requirements. Instead, it took almost two weeks for an Essex County Juvenile Court judge to rule DCF made a mistake, a period during which mother and child would have begun forming their first strong bonds. “The trauma of removal itself is compounded with every additional hour,” said Richard Wexler, executive director of the National Coalition For Child Protection Reform, which focused CUSTODY, Page A8

But is it art? These flashy ‘museums’ test tradition

Immersive venues mix culture and entertainment

By Malcolm Gay
GLOBE STAFF
No one enters the Museum of Ice Cream’s new Seaport outpost unnoticed. A glossy playscape of Instagram fame, the museum urges guests to adopt an ice cream persona during their visit and “unleash your inner child.” On a recent weekday, an attendant named “KitKat” leveled a challenge at a group of visitors before she’d even opened the door to the museum’s candy-colored interior. “You’ve got to be extra, extra loud,” she said, “and literally scream for ice cream!” The guests, now sporting nicknames such as “Frozone” and “Sprinkles,” obliged. With its “lobster roll” confectations, “Creamliner” fuselage, and signature ball pit of giant sprinkles, the Museum of Ice Cream is a far cry from the Isabella Stewart Gardner Museum MUSEUMS, Page A14



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF
A pool of giant sprinkles at the Museum of Ice Cream outpost in the Seaport.



It’s Oscar night

Who will win? Who should win? Who should not even be there? Check your picks against film critic Odie Henderson’s. **SundayArts, N1.**
AJ Dybantsa, a basketball phenom from Brockton, is navigating his way to NBA stardom with this family’s help. **Globe Magazine.**
David Johansen has died. The last surviving member of the glam and protopunk band the New York Dolls was 75. **A21.**

Time to re-cover

Sunday: Sunny, colder. High: 29-34. Low: 10-15.
Monday: Sunny, windy. High: 28-33. Low: 20-25.
Sunrise: 6:18 Sunset: 5:35
Complete report, **A22.**
Deaths, **A16-21.**

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